

Gauss' Theorem

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21. Divergence Theorem of Gauss

21.1

THEOREM 1

Divergence Theorem of Gauss

(Transformation Between Triple and Surface Integrals)

Let T be a closed bounded region in space whose boundary is a piecewise smooth orientable surface S . Let $\mathbf{F}(x, y, z)$ be a vector function that is continuous and has continuous first partial derivatives in some domain containing T . Then

$$(2) \quad \iiint_T \operatorname{div} \mathbf{F} \, dV = \iint_S \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{n} \, dA.$$

In components of $\mathbf{F} = [F_1, F_2, F_3]$ and of the outer unit normal vector $\mathbf{n} = [\cos \alpha, \cos \beta, \cos \gamma]$ of S (as in Fig. 253), formula (2) becomes

$$(2^*) \quad \begin{aligned} \iiint_T \left(\frac{\partial F_1}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial F_3}{\partial z} \right) dx \, dy \, dz \\ = \iint_S (F_1 \cos \alpha + F_2 \cos \beta + F_3 \cos \gamma) \, dA \\ = \iint_S (F_1 \, dy \, dz + F_2 \, dz \, dx + F_3 \, dx \, dy). \end{aligned}$$

21.2

Verification of the Divergence Theorem

Evaluate $\iint_S (7x\mathbf{i} - z\mathbf{k}) \cdot \mathbf{n} \, dA$ over the sphere $S: x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 4$

Soln First we compute the surface integral.

Parameterize S :

$$\vec{r} = [2\cos v \cos u, 2\cos v \sin u, 2\sin v] \quad , \quad 0 \leq u \leq 2\pi, \quad -\frac{\pi}{2} \leq v \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{So } \vec{r}_u &= [-2\cos v \sin u, 2\cos v \cos u, 0] \\ \vec{r}_v &= [-2\sin v \cos u, -2\sin v \sin u, 2\cos v] \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Thus } \vec{N} = \vec{r}_u \times \vec{r}_v = \begin{bmatrix} 4\cos^2 v \cos u \\ 4\cos^2 v \sin u \\ 4\cos v \sin v \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\text{Thus } \vec{N} = \vec{r}_u \times \vec{r}_v = \begin{bmatrix} 4\cos^2 v \cos u \\ 4\cos^2 v \sin u \\ 4\cos v \sin v \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\text{and } \vec{F} = \begin{bmatrix} 7x \\ 0 \\ -z \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 14\cos v \cos u \\ 0 \\ -2\sin v \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\text{So then: } \vec{F} \cdot \vec{N} = 56\cos^3 v \cos^2 u - 8\cos v \sin^2 v$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Then } \oint_S \vec{F} \cdot \hat{n} dA &= \int_{-\pi/2}^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} (56\cos^3 v \cos^2 u - 8\cos v \sin^2 v) du dv \\ &= \int_{-\pi/2}^{\pi/2} \int_0^{2\pi} (28\cos^3 v (\cos 2u + 1) - 8\cos v \sin^2 v) du dv \\ &= \int_{-\pi/2}^{\pi/2} \left[28\cos^3 v \left(\frac{1}{2} \sin 2u + u \right) - 8u \cos v \sin^2 v \right]_0^{2\pi} dv \\ &= \int_{-\pi/2}^{\pi/2} (56\pi \cos^3 v - 16\pi \cos v \sin^2 v) dv \\ &= \left[56\pi \left(\sin v - \frac{\sin^3 v}{3} \right) - 16\pi \frac{\sin^3 v}{3} \right]_{-\pi/2}^{\pi/2} \\ &= 56\pi \left(1 - \frac{1}{3} \right) - 16\pi \left(\frac{1}{3} \right) + 56\pi \left(1 - \frac{1}{3} \right) - 16\pi \left(\frac{1}{3} \right) \\ &= 56\pi \left(\frac{2}{3} \right) \times 2 - 16\pi \left(\frac{2}{3} \right) = \pi \left[\frac{112 - 16 \times 2}{3} \right] \\ &= \pi \left[\frac{96}{3} \times 2 \right] = \pi [32 \times 2] = 64\pi \end{aligned}$$

Next, we use the divergence theorem.

$$\text{for } \vec{F} = 7x\hat{i} - z\hat{k}$$

$$\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{F} = \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(7x) + \frac{\partial}{\partial y}(0) + \frac{\partial}{\partial z}(-z) = 7 + 0 - 1 = 6$$

Now for the sphere $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 \leq 4$:

$$\begin{aligned} \iiint_V \vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{F} dV &= \iiint_V 6 dV = 6 \underbrace{\iiint_V dV}_{\text{Volume of sphere of radius 2}} = 6 \left(\frac{4}{3} \pi (2)^3 \right) = 6 \times \frac{4}{3} \pi \times 8 \\ &= 64\pi \end{aligned}$$

sphere of
radius 2

2.3 Use the divergence theorem to evaluate $\iint_S \vec{F} \cdot \hat{n} \, dA$ for

$$\vec{F} = [x^2, 0, z^2], \quad S: \text{surface of the box}$$
$$|x| \leq 1, \quad |y| \leq 3, \quad 0 \leq z \leq 2$$

Soln First we find

$$\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{F} = \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(x^2) + \frac{\partial}{\partial y}(0) + \frac{\partial}{\partial z}(z^2) = 2x + 2z$$

The volume is the box, so $-1 \leq x \leq 1, -3 \leq y \leq 3, 0 \leq z \leq 2$

$$\iint_S \vec{F} \cdot \hat{n} \, dA = \iiint_V \vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{F} \, dV = \int_0^2 \int_{-1}^1 \int_{-3}^3 (2x + 2z) \, dy \, dx \, dz$$

$$= \int_0^2 \int_{-1}^1 [2xy + 2zy]_{-3}^3 \, dx \, dz$$

$$= \int_0^2 \int_{-1}^1 (12x + 12z) \, dx \, dz$$

$$= \int_0^2 [6x^2 + 12xz]_{-1}^1 \, dz$$

$$= \int_0^2 (6(1)^2 + 12(1)z - 6(-1)^2 - 12(-1)z) \, dz$$

$$= \int_0^2 24z \, dz = 12z^2 \Big|_0^2 = 12(2)^2 - 0 = 48.$$

